

pilgrimage destinations globally, attracting millions of devotees every year. The presence of such iconic spiritual centres makes the state a cornerstone of India's religious tourism landscape. Beyond Tirumala, major pilgrimage destinations such as Srisailam Temple, Simhachalam Temple and Kanaka Durga Temple continue to draw pilgrims from across the country and abroad, reinforcing the state's identity as a spiritual hub. Every year millions of devotees visit these sacred sites, making religious tourism one of the strongest contributors to the state's visitor economy.

COASTAL AND ECO TOURISM

Complementing its religious tourism circuit is Andhra Pradesh's extraordinary natural beauty. The Eastern Ghats that run across the northern districts offer scenic hill destinations such as Araku Valley and Lambasingi, known for their lush forests, coffee plantations and cool climate. Pristine beaches along the Bay of Bengal, destinations such as Rushikonda Beach and Bheemili are gaining popularity among domestic travellers.

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These destinations have witnessed a steady increase in tourist footfall in recent years, particularly among younger travellers seeking eco-tourism and adventure experiences. The government is developing these regions with improved road connectivity, eco-resorts and community-based tourism initiatives to ensure sustainable growth while preserving fragile ecosystems.

The government is now investing in modern tourism infrastructure, including coastal tourism circuits, Cruise tourism infrastructure, Heritage and temple tourism development and hospitality facilities. These initiatives aim to position Andhra Pradesh as a major tourism destination in southern India.

